

the World. Unfortunately, it was destroyed by an earthquake in 226 BCE. According to legend, the statue was an immense figure that straddled the entrance to the harbor at Rhodes. It is thought to have been 108 ft (33 m) high, which would make it by far the largest statue of the Classical world. However, it remains an enigma. Almost all that can be said with any certainty is that the figure was created in 292–280 BCE, and was clad in bronze. It was the work of Chares of Lindos,

whose teacher, Lysippus, had been responsible for an 58-ft- (18-m-) high bronze statue of Hercules in Taranto in southern Italy.

Pompeii

Location Pompeii, Italy

The city of Pompeii, along with its neighbor on the Bay of Naples, Herculaneum, was

buried deep below layers of ash and rock by an eruption of Mount Vesuvius in 79 CE. Miraculously, it was largely preserved intact and was rediscovered in the 18th century. Presenting a moment frozen in time, its excavation transformed our understanding of Roman life. Much of what is known of Roman painting comes from the frescoes discovered here. Pompeii's forum, temples, and huge amphitheater attest to the

priorities of Roman society. Of the many houses, some are sumptuous, with colonnaded courtyards and gardens, but most are humble, giving a glimpse of the normal Romans' daily life. The layout of the city is largely a regular grid plan based on two principal streets running northeast, with blocks of buildings covering some 38,000 square ft (3,530 square m).

▼ FORUM BATH IN THE ANCIENT ROMAN CITY OF POMPEII

